



Curran, Ben

ZIM

vs right-arm pace

Zimbabwe M · LHB · How to exploit — right-arm pace plan

RUNS

213

4 dismissals · 11 inns

AVERAGE

53.2

STRIKE RATE

85.5

3-YR 85.5

MEDIAN % OF RUNS

13.7%

of team, per innings

3-YR 10.0%

CARRIES THE INNINGS

45%

innings with ≥25% of team

3-YR 25%

SUMMARY

- Plan for right-arm pace: bowl **good length pitching on the stumps**.
- They get out most often to balls that are **good length and down the leg side** (3.7 dismissals/100).
- Most often out **caught behind** (25% of dismissals); most often to right fast (3).

COMMON THEMES

- left-hand bat, averaging 53.2 at a strike rate of 85.5.
- Carries a big share of the batting — 23.2% of team runs.
- Scores mainly through the off side (49%).

STRENGTHS

- Main scoring shot is the work/nudge (33% of runs).

WEAKNESSES / HOW TO GET HIM

- Most often out **caught behind** (25% of dismissals); most often to right fast (3).
- Vulnerable to the **good length** (averages 34 there vs 53 overall; 2.0 dismissals/100).
- Most dangerous ball: **good length and down the leg side** (3.7 dismissals/100, avg 16).
- His **drive** is high-risk (false shot 41%, 2.3 outs/100).

v **Bangladesh** · 1 Test · 51 balls · 42 runs · avg 42.0
Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

v **Afghanistan** · 1 Test · 256 balls · 121 runs · avg 121.0
Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

v **New Zealand** · 1 Test · 46 balls · 24 runs · avg 12.0
Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

Only the balls of each attack's pace plan that differed from what the same bowlers gave that side's other LHB top-order batters. The full dismissal detail sits in the vision playlists.

Our Best Options (simulated matchups)

From the match simulation — a tool that plays each batter-v-bowler pairing out thousands of times from their full Test profiles. Low expected average = the bowler wins the matchup. "Cohort" confidence = they have not faced enough of that type for a personal read.

Bowler	Type	Exp avg	Exp SR	Out in first 30 %	Stock wicket ball	Top dismissal	Confidence
Xavier Bartlett	Right pace	21.0	76.9	60.0	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 26.4%	Cohort
Josh Hazlewood	Right pace	27.1	74.0	49.5	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 26.0%	Cohort
Adam Zampa	Leg-spin	32.3	91.6	55.8	good length, outside off	LBW 21.5%	Cohort
Nathan Ellis	Right pace	33.1	84.9	47.6	short, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.2%	Cohort
Mitch Marsh	Right pace	34.5	88.5	48.3	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 25.4%	Cohort

Structurally, off-spin turning the ball away from the LHB is the matchup class that persists — favour that angle when the individual reads are thin.

Where They're Vulnerable (right-arm pace)

Per bucket: batting average, strike rate, false-shot %, dismissals per 100 balls, boundary %. Pink row = their lowest-average (softest) bucket in that dimension.

Length

Length	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Good length	34.0	69	31%	2.04	4%	49

Pitching line

Pitching line	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
on the stumps	56.0	82	33%	1.47	10%	204

Over vs round

Over vs round	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Round the wicket	27.5	87	34%	3.17	10%	63
Over the wicket	79.0	85	31%	1.08	11%	186

DANGER BALL — WHERE THEY'RE MOST LIKELY OUT

▶ WATCH DANGER BALLS

Good length / down the leg side

3.7 dismissals per 100 · averages 16 here · 27 balls · false shot 21%

How They Score & Get Out

Scores most of their runs through the off side (49%; off 49% · leg 30% · straight 21%).

Shot types (risk) [▶ their drive](#)

Shot	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Drive	60.0	136	41%	2.27	23%	44
Work/Nudge	—	66	32%	0.00	2%	106

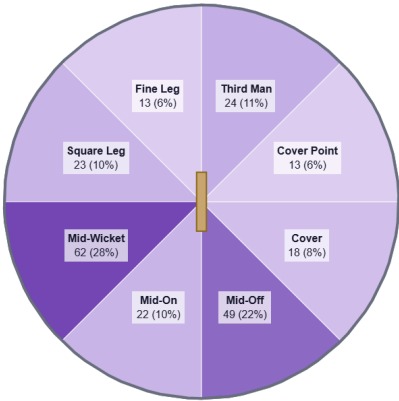
Scoring mix vs the typical Test batter (vs pace)

Shot	% of their runs	Typical	Index	Pctl
Drive	32%	34%	1.0×	P44
Work/Nudge	32%	28%	1.2×	P72
Pull/Hook	22%	20%	1.1×	P66
Cut	7%	8%	1.0×	P48
Ramp/Scoop	4%	1%	7.4×	P90
Slog	2%	5%	0.3×	P20
Sweep	0%	0%	0.0×	P44

Share of stroke-coded runs vs pace; index = their share ÷ cohort median (171 Test batters). Highlight = signature shot; ▼ = scores unusually little there.

Most often out **caught behind** (25% of dismissals); most often to right fast (3). [▶ watch dismissals](#)

Dismissal mode	Count	%
Caught behind	1	25%
Caught in the field	1	25%
Caught	1	25%
Run Out	1	25%



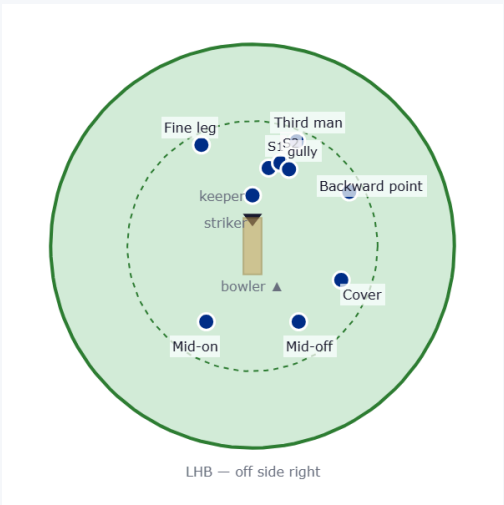
Where they score — runs by area vs right-arm pace (mirrored for a left-hander).

Suggested Fields (the stock field ± their evidenced deviations)

Each field starts from the **stock template** for that bowler type & phase (orthodox because it works), then makes at most **three** changes — each one earned by a trigger in **their** game clearing the cohort P75 bar (do they lap, cut, pull, score square, edge early?). **Change** rows are highlighted with their stat; **Stock** rows carry the orthodox line. The read line backtests the changes against the pure stock field. Early = first 30 balls; Set = once in. Drawn from behind the bowler (bowler bottom, striker top); off side is on the right.

Field vs right-arm pace

Early — first 30 balls · 150 balls

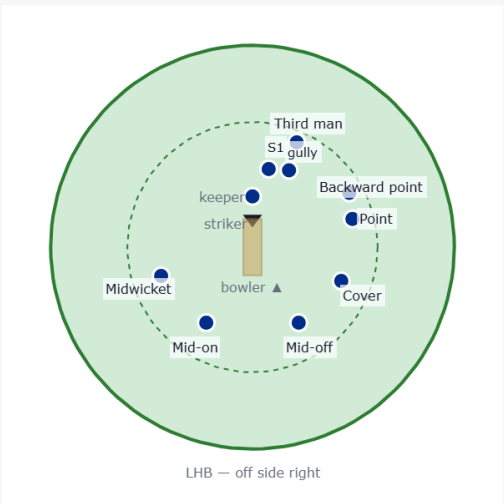


Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
2nd slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Gully	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Fine leg	Stock	Standard stock position.
Third man	Stock	Standard stock position.

Pure stock field. Nothing in their game clears the deviation bar (cohort P75) against right-arm pace, so the orthodox field stands — that is the read.

Floating fielder: They score only 0% of their runs where mid-off stands — the spare run-saver to move as the game asks.

Once set · 99 balls



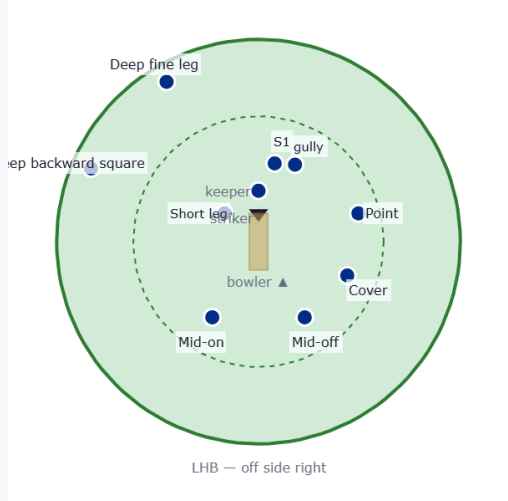
Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Gully	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Midwicket	Stock	Standard stock position.
Third man	Stock	Standard stock position.

Pure off-side / square stock field — Scores square and through the off (54% vs 29% leg) — an extra fielder square on the off, one leg-sider out..

Nothing in their game clears the deviation bar (cohort P75) against right-arm pace, so the orthodox field stands — that is the read.

Floating fielder: They score only 2% of their runs where third man stands — the spare run-saver to move as the game asks.

Bouncer plan



He pulls a fair amount (P61) — the bumper can buy a top-edge. One slip, a catcher in front of square, and the two legal leg-side riders (deep backward square + deep fine leg).

Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Change	One slip kept for the top / outside edge.
Short leg	Change	Catcher in front of square for the fend or glove off the hip.
Gully	Change	The steer or fend that flies squarer of the wicket.
Point	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Cover	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Mid-off	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Mid-on	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Deep backward square	Change	Deep behind square for the top-edged pull.
Deep fine leg	Change	Deep behind square for the hook.